# Nivea in India: A Sales & Distribution Management Analysis

Nov 1, 2026 · @Isagi Yoichi

## 1. Executive summary

Nivea India's growth depends less on brand awareness than on whether its distribution system can turn existing brand trust into shelf presence at the right cost. This report re-reads the original Nivea report through the Sales and Distribution Management (SDM) course material, adds fresh research, and flags what remains unknown.

**Scope of the cross-check.** The SDM folder contains no material on Nivea or Beiersdorf (a text search of every readable file returned zero matches). The cross-check is therefore framework-to-case: each SDM tool (channel design, flows, conflict, sales-force decisions, the selling process) is applied to Nivea facts, with FMCG cases from the folder (Mondelez, Birla Opus) used as benchmarks.

### Five findings

1. **Brand pull is strong, share is invisible.** Nivea was ranked the No. 1 skincare brand in TRA's Brand Trust Report 2026 for the sixth year (per the original report), yet no overall India market share is published. Pull lets a brand buy coverage cheaply; without a share figure, how much pull Nivea really has in each channel stays unproven.
2. **The channel is a standard indirect FMCG system, and only half of it is confirmed.** Nivea's job postings confirm a General Trade field line (Area Sales Managers) and a key-account-led Modern Trade line. Distributors, depots and margins are not disclosed, so the distributor layer remains an SDM inference.
3. **The global parent is showing a primary-versus-secondary gap.** In H1 2026 Beiersdorf reported Nivea sales of EUR 2,703m, down 6.8% organically, while sell-out stayed positive and shipments into trade fell, citing customer conflicts and trade destocking (Beiersdorf, 3 Aug 2026). That release does not mention India, so it must not be read as an India result. It is the exact pattern SDM warns about: dispatch is not consumption.
4. **Quick commerce is the sharpest live channel conflict.** India's consumer-products distributors told the Competition Commission that quick-commerce platforms discount 35-50% below distributor prices (Outlook Business). Nivea has not disclosed

how it handles this, and its June 2026 Real Madrid fan campaign runs through e-commerce partners only (Impact).

5. **The selling craft differs at each node.** At the kirana it is outside order-taking with brand pull; at modern trade it is negotiation with a key account; with distributors it is closer to client-profit planning. One pitch does not fit all three.

## SDM read of Nivea India (analytical, not company-confirmed)

| Element | Reading |
|---|---|
| Selling situation | Outside order taker at general-trade retailers; creative-tangible when winning a new distributor; key-account negotiation in modern trade |
| Selling strategy | Persuasion at the retailer, Negotiation with distributors and chains on margin, credit and schemes |
| Selling style | Direct and Commercial in the field; Commercial and Technical at key accounts |
| Stir point (X-factor) | For the retailer: brand pull plus a margin and scheme that beats the shelf-space alternative; for the distributor: return on investment, not headline margin |
| Intensity and governance | Intensive distribution in general trade, key-account in modern trade; administered rather than contractual, since Nivea publishes no distributor agreements |

## What the cross-check changed

| Item | Original report | After cross-check |
|---|---|---|
| Sanand plant capacity | About 80 million units a year | 100 million units a year per Indian Retailer, May 2015; the 80 million figure needs a source or removal |

| Item | Original report | After cross-check |
|---|---|---|
| Nivea global sales | FY2025 EUR 5.529bn, +0.9% organic | Still correct for FY2025, but H1 2026 is EUR 2.703bn, -6.8% organic, so the 2025 figure alone now misleads |
| SDM coverage | Metrics list in section 6 only | Adds territory design, quotas, compensation, conflict measurement, distributor selection and the full selling process |
| Audience | Written for one friend with an arts background | Reframed as a neutral reference for both of you |

## 2. Company, brand and sponsorship as sources of channel power

Nivea's history matters to a sales manager for one reason: a trusted brand changes what the channel will accept. Beiersdorf was founded on 28 March 1882 in Hamburg; Oscar Troplowitz took over in 1890 and, with Paul Gerson Unna and Isaac Lifschutz, built Nivea Creme on the emulsifier Eucerit (patented 1900). The cream reached the market in December 1911, aimed at high-quality skin care affordable to all. These dates come from the original report, which sourced them to Beiersdorf and Nivea history pages.

### Milestones that shaped the range a rep sells today

| Year | Milestone | Why a sales manager cares |
|---|---|---|
| 1911 | Nivea Creme launches in the yellow tin | One hero SKU built the brand's trust |
| 1925 | Relaunch in the blue tin | A stable pack identity makes shelf recognition easy |
| 1963 | Nivea Milk, liquid body care | Body lotion becomes the volume category in India |
| 1978-96 | Shower, aftershave balm, Visage, For Men, hair, bath care | Range extension multiplies SKUs per outlet |
| 2014 | In-shower body lotion | Premium innovation pulled through to modern trade |

| Year | Milestone | Why a sales manager cares |
|---|---|---|
| FY2025 | Nivea sales EUR 5.529bn, +0.9% organic | Global base the India business draws brand support from |
| H1 2026 | Nivea EUR 2.703bn, -6.8% organic; 18-month turnaround plan | Global pressure and a plan to raise media spend by EUR 100m in H2 2026 (Beiersdorf) |

## Push and pull: the SDM lens on sponsorship

SDM treats a channel as the set of interdependent organisations that make a product available, and treats margin as the price of coverage. A brand with strong consumer pull pays less for that coverage. The Birla Opus case in your Group 9 work states it bluntly: the market leader needs to offer a dealer only about 5% because dealers stock it regardless, while the challenger pays 10-15% to buy the same shelf space. That is a primary interview figure from the group's own field work, not company disclosure.

Nivea's sponsorships work on the pull side of that equation.

- **Real Madrid.** Nivea Men became the club's official sponsor in Spain in 2013, went global across 70+ countries in 2017, and extended to 2030 in October 2025, now also covering selected Nivea, Liposan and Labello products (original report, sourced to realmadrid.com and trade press). Nivea cited that 55% of men worldwide are football fans.
- **India activation.** On 16 June 2026 Nivea Men announced an India fan campaign: buyers above a set spend on partner e-commerce platforms enter to win a trip to Spain and club merchandise. The release names no sales target, names no platforms and does not mention retail (Impact). The article also gives the rollout window as June to October 2027, which conflicts with its 2026 date, so treat the end date as unverified.

**SDM reading.** A campaign that routes purchases only through e-commerce is a pull investment aimed at the one channel that already competes with the distributor. Whether it helps or hurts the general-trade distributor depends on whether Nivea pairs it with an equivalent retail activation. The sources do not say it does.

# 3. India: entry, footprint and what is known about market position

Nivea reached India through imports long before it built a company here, and its manufacturing and leadership choices since 2015 show a deliberate move from importer to local competitor. The table separates what is documented from what is only claimed.

## Entry and footprint

| Item | Fact | Source and confidence |
|---|---|---|
| First presence | Imports from the 1930s; Beiersdorf's CEO dates the first Indian sale to 1913 | Original report; the two dates conflict and are unresolved |
| Legal entity | Nivea India Pvt Ltd, HQ Mumbai, set up 2006 (some sources say 2005) | Original report; year disputed |
| Sanand plant | Opened May 2015, Rs 850 crore, 100 million units a year, about 200 staff, makes creams, lotions, shower products and lip care | Indian Retailer; original report said 80 million units, which this source contradicts |
| Still imported | Deodorants and soaps; import dependence about 30% at opening, planned to fall by 15 over three years | Indian Retailer; the article does not say whether that is points or a relative cut |
| Other plant | Goa, since 1993 | Original report |
| Leadership | Geetika Mehta appointed Managing Director in January 2024; previously Managing Director of Hershey India and about two decades at Hindustan Unilever | Indian Retailer |
| Group ambition | CEO Vincent Warnery (Feb 2025): India is a top-10 country with two brands; aim to double sales and build a EUR 500m business | Original report, sourced to a CNBC-TV18 interview; not re-verified here |
| New launches | Nivea Face planned for India in Q1 2025 with the Luminous 630 range; Eucerin to launch in 2024; India called a "key geographical white spot" | Cosmetics Design Asia, Aug 2024 |

| Item | Fact | Source and confidence |
|---|---|---|
| Local flexibility | FY2025 results name China, the US, India, Japan and Brazil as markets given greater scope to adapt portfolios and execution | Beiersdorf, 2 Mar 2026 |

Two details matter for sales. First, the plant announcement promised smaller pack sizes at multiple price points, which in SDM terms raises the **bulk-breaking** service output the end customer demands. Second, a Managing Director who spent two decades at Hindustan Unilever and then ran Hershey India brings a mass-distribution background to a business whose stated lever is reach.

## Market position: known, claimed, unknown

| Claim | Figure | Status |
|---|---|---|
| Share of skin cream market, 2006 | 19% of a Rs 108 crore market | Case-study figure, nearly two decades old |
| Cold cream share, Oct 2023 | 32% | Marketing director interview |
| Shower gel | Company claims India's No. 1 brand | 2018 company statement |
| Brand trust | No. 1 skincare brand, TRA Brand Trust Report 2026, sixth consecutive year | Original report |
| Overall Nivea India share | Not published | Unknown |
| Body lotion market size | USD 263 million versus USD 1.17 billion in different third-party estimates | Conflicting; do not cite without checking definitions |

**What the Beiersdorf releases do and do not say about India.** The H1 2026 release reports the Africa, Asia and Australia consumer region at -2.1% organic and never mentions India by name. FY2025 for that region was +4.5% organic. Both are regional aggregates, so neither can be attributed to Nivea India. The honest summary is that India's contribution to either number is not disclosed.

### Brand ambassadors as pull assets

| Person | Role | Channel relevance |
|---|---|---|
| Taapsee Pannu | Shower gel ambassador from April 2018; named Nivea's first Indian global brand ambassador in April 2025 with Soft Daily UV | Supports the face and sun push that needs modern-trade and online availability |
| Ranveer Singh | Nivea Men ambassador from August 2018 | Young male grooming, deodorant and face wash |
| Anushka Sharma | Body lotion face around the 100-year celebration; latest confirmed mention 2018 | Current status unknown |
| Rohit Saraf | June 2026 'Upar Upar Se' campaign for Super 10 Serum Lotion | Premium body lotion |

Ambassador lists come from the original report, sourced to trade press. An ambassador creates demand; it does not by itself create availability. The sales system has to convert that demand at the shelf.

## 4. Product portfolio and category dynamics

Nivea sells one brand into five different buying behaviours, and each behaviour pulls the channel in a different direction. The SDM course says product characteristics set channel structure before anything else: bulk and weight, perishability, unit value, standardisation, technical content and newness. Nivea's core range is standardised, non-technical, shelf-stable and low in unit value, which is why it suits long, intensive, indirect channels in general trade.

### What nivea.in shows

The site has four top-level categories: Body, Face, Men and Sun. As read in October 2026 for the original report, Body lists 40 products, Face 23 and Men 21, and Sun states no total. The original report names a partial list of products (it says 45 verified; the roughly 84 total it cites excludes Sun, so the full range is larger). A complete SKU master is a gap that only Nivea or a distributor can close.

| Category | Representative products named in the original report |
|---|---|
| Body lotions and creams | Nourishing Lotion Body Milk; Aloe Hydration Body Lotion; Super 10 Youth Serum Lotion (170 ml); Soft Peppy Pomegranate |
| Shower gels | Frangipani and Oil; Lemongrass and Oil; Powerfruit; Waterlily and Oil |
| Deodorants (women and men) | Pearl and Beauty Radiance Roll On; Derma Control Eventone Roll On; Deep Impact, Fresh Power spray; Protect and Care Anti-Perspirant Spray (150 ml) |
| Face | Milk Delights Saffron, Turmeric and Honey Face Wash; Luminous Even Glow Face Wash and Day Cream SPF 50; Derma Skin Clear Toner; Soft Daily UV SPF-15 cream |
| Lip care | Watermelon Shine; Strawberry Shine; Original; Men Active Lip Balm |
| Men | Men Creme; Dark Spot Reduction Creme; face washes (Acne, Deep Impact, Oil Control); shower gels |
| Sun | SPF 30 and SPF 50 lotions; Kids lotion; Invisible spray; UV Face SPF 50 |

## Category behaviour and what it means for selling

| Category | Buying behaviour | Season | Dominant SDM selling situation | Channel implication |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cold cream and body lotion | Habitual, brand-trusting | Peak in winter | Outside order taker | Winter stocking decisions are made months earlier, so autumn secondary sales matter |

| Category | Buying behaviour | Season | Dominant SDM selling situation | Channel implication |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Shower gel | Considered trade-up from soap | Year-round | Outside order taker | Needs mid-tier shelf space in general trade and chemist |
| Deodorant | Impulse-driven, low loyalty | Peak in summer | Outside order taker with scheme | Visibility and scheme sensitivity decide the sale; hard to hold by brand alone |
| Sun care | Seasonal, education needed | Summer | Missionary toward the consumer, order taker toward the retailer | Modern trade and online carry most of the learning |
| Face care and Derma | High involvement, small basket of brands | Year-round | Creative selling of a tangible, closer to missionary | Chemist, modern trade and e-commerce where advice and range are available |
| Men's grooming | Identity-led, influenced by football and celebrity | Year-round | Direct, brand-pull led | Heavy e-commerce and modern-trade skew likely, but not disclosed |

The season and involvement patterns above are the original report's category notes; the SDM situation labels are this report's analytical reading.

## Reading the portfolio as a channel problem

1. **A hero SKU subsidises coverage.** The Nivea Creme tin and body lotion open doors; the rep then has to sell the assortment behind them. In SDM terms this is **assorting** at the kirana: building a mixed portfolio that fits the retailer's limited space.

2. **Premium launches change who must be convinced.** Super 10 (a premium serum lotion) and the Luminous and Derma lines carry higher unit value. They need distributors who will stock slower-moving lines and retailers whom reps can persuade to give them space.
3. **Seasonality turns primary sales into a forecasting contract.** SDM's conflict material names forecast disagreement as a source of friction: a company may plan on 20% growth while the dealer commits inventory for 8%. Winter and summer peaks make that disagreement predictable for Nivea.
4. **Smaller packs are a service-output decision.** The 2015 plant announcement promised smaller packs at multiple price points. That serves the bulk-breaking demand of price-sensitive buyers but multiplies SKUs the distributor must carry.

## 5. Distribution system design: what Nivea confirms and what SDM lets us infer

The SDM rule is never to begin a channel answer with structure. Begin with the service outputs the buyer demands, then treat structure as a cost question. Applying that to Nivea gives a design that matches what the job postings reveal, with the distributor layer remaining an inference.

### Step 1: Service output demands by shopper

| Shopper and outlet | Service outputs that matter most | Channel that delivers them |
|---|---|---|
| Neighbourhood shopper at a kirana, chemist or cosmetic store | Spatial convenience, bulk breaking (small packs), assortment of a few trusted brands | General trade through distributors |
| Family shopper in a supermarket or hypermarket | Assortment depth, information, promotions | Modern trade key accounts |
| Trade buyer at a cash-and-carry | Bulk, price, credit | Cash and carry, organised trade |

| Shopper and outlet | Service outputs that matter most | Channel that delivers them |
|---|---|---|
| Digital shopper | Delivery time, assortment, information, convenience | E-commerce, quick commerce, Nivea's own website (launched December 2020) |
| Skin-concern buyer (Derma, Face) | Information and customer service | Chemist, modern trade, online |

## Step 2: What is confirmed about structure

Nivea's own job postings, quoted in the original report, show the organisation behind the channels.

| Confirmed | Detail |
|---|---|
| Organised trade vertical | A Head of Modern Trade, Cash and Carry and Alternate Channels runs three verticals and carries annual sales targets |
| General trade field line | Area Sales Managers own General Trade sales performance in an assigned territory, as Nivea India defines the channel |
| Modern trade model | Regional Key Account Managers build chains through alliances, consumer promotions and monthly journey plans, and keep a database of modern-trade outlets |
| Regional roles | Channel-cluster growth, trade scheme efficiency and damage management |
| Leadership | Sales director Srikanth Iyer (Dec 2024, from Kimberly-Clark route to market); e-commerce director hired Jan 2025 |

Nivea has not disclosed distributor names, carry-and-forward agents, margins, credit terms or the channel mix. The next table therefore labels each element as confirmed or inferred.

## Step 3: The route map

| Route | Path | Evidence |
|---|---|---|
| A. General trade | Plant or import port, then carrying-and-forwarding point, then distributor, then retailer, then consumer | Inferred from the Area Sales Manager role and standard FMCG practice; the original report says the same |
| B. Modern trade | Company, then chain depot or store, then shopper, handled by key accounts | Confirmed organisation; physical flow inferred |
| C. Cash and carry | Company, then wholesale format, then trade buyer | Confirmed vertical; flow inferred |
| D. E-commerce and quick commerce | Company or distributor, then platform or dark store, then consumer | Confirmed that e-commerce leadership exists; arrangements with Blinkit, Zepto, Amazon or Nykaa not confirmed |
| E. Direct to consumer | Nivea's own website, launched December 2020 | Confirmed |

The general-trade chain figures in the original report (12+ million stores, 70-75% of FMCG sales) are industry figures, not Nivea data. For comparison, Mondelez India reports serving 3 million mom-and-pop stores and 20% of sales through modern trade and e-commerce, as recorded in your Mondelez assignment from its public disclosures. Nivea has published nothing equivalent.

## Step 4: The eight flows and who plausibly carries them

SDM's central point on flows is that you can remove an intermediary but not his flows. Only the payer changes. The table assigns each flow to the likely carrier in general trade and states what Nivea would take on if it bypassed the distributor.

| Flow | Direction | Likely general-trade carrier (inferred) | If Nivea bypassed the distributor |
|---|---|---|---|
| Physical possession | Forward | Distributor warehouse and vans | Nivea funds storage and last-mile delivery |

| Flow | Direction | Likely general-trade carrier (inferred) | If Nivea bypassed the distributor |
|---|---|---|---|
| Ownership | Forward | Distributor holds stock | Nivea carries inventory longer |
| Promotion | Forward | Nivea media; field team and distributor salesmen at the outlet | Nivea hires more reps |
| Negotiation | Both ways | Area Sales Manager with distributor; distributor salesman with retailer | Nivea negotiates with thousands of retailers |
| Financing | Both ways | Distributor funds stock and extends retailer credit | Nivea carries receivables |
| Risking | Both ways | Damage, expiry and claims shared; claims management is listed in regional roles | Nivea absorbs more claims |
| Ordering | Backward | Distributor salesman books orders; company processes distributor orders | Higher order-processing cost |
| Payment | Backward | Retailer pays distributor, distributor pays company | Collections and bad debt move to Nivea |

The arithmetic behind this: three makers selling directly to five retailers need 3 x 5 = 15 contacts, while one intermediary cuts that to 3 + 5 = 8. An intermediary turns multiplication into addition. Any case for dropping Nivea's distributors must beat that arithmetic and the flow costs above, not merely dislike the margin.

## Step 5: Intensity and governance

- **Intensity.** General trade is intensive because Nivea's customers are dispersed, buy in small frequent lots and expect immediate availability. Modern trade is selective by nature: few powerful buyers. Derma and premium lines may justify a more selective chemist and modern-trade route, though nothing confirms that Nivea does this.
- **Governance.** With no public distributor agreement, the system is best described as administered: Nivea sets schemes, targets and standards through its field team, rather than owning the partner or binding it by a published contract.

- **Contrast with Birla Opus.** Your Group 9 case shows a channel built the other way: paint is tinted at the counter, so there is no bulk to break and the company runs depots directly to dealers with no distributor between. Nivea's products are finished goods in many SKUs, so the case for a distributor holding stock and credit is stronger.

### Step 6: Variables that shape the structure

Professor Prashar's sheet lists market, product, company and intermediary variables and leaves the behavioural and environmental ones blank for students to fill. Here is Nivea's full set.

| Variable | Nivea reading |
|---|---|
| Market | Dispersed demand; small, frequent purchases; rising online share |
| Product | Standardised, shelf-stable, low unit value, many SKUs, seasonal peaks |
| Company | Challenger in India, with local plant and a stated aim to double sales; reach is the lever |
| Intermediary | Large distributor pool; cost and service not public |
| Behavioural | Distributors want return on capital and fair treatment; quick commerce reshapes retailer and distributor expectations; goodwill is a stock spent on how failures are read |
| Environmental | GST and e-commerce rules; competition-law complaints against platforms; Beiersdorf's 18-month global turnaround; consumer shift to online and to quick commerce |

## 6. Distributor economics and channel conflict

A distributor keeps pushing a brand when its return on capital beats the alternatives, and stops when it does not, whatever the headline margin says. This section applies the SDM material on distributor economics, primary versus secondary sales and channel conflict to Nivea.

## Return on capital, not headline margin

Your Mondelez assignment states the test directly: the correct measure is return on investment, because a lower margin can stay attractive when stock turns fast and claims settle quickly, while a high margin can destroy return when inventory, retailer credit, damage or expiry lock up capital. A simple illustration with hypothetical numbers, not Nivea data: a 4% margin turned 12 times a year earns 48% gross on stock, while an 8% margin turned 4 times earns 32%.

| Driver | Why it moves distributor return | Nivea relevance |
|---|---|---|
| Margin on invoice | Income per unit sold | Not disclosed; do not guess |
| Stock turns | Capital is tied up for fewer days | Seasonal lines (winter creams, summer sun and deodorant) turn unevenly |
| Credit extended to retailers | Receivables lock up working capital | Retailer credit practice not disclosed |
| Damage, expiry and claims | Losses and slow settlement | Claims and damage management appear in Nivea's regional roles |
| Fixed costs of salesmen, vans, godown | Must be spread over volume | Many SKUs raise handling cost per rupee sold |
| Scheme funding and settlement | Delays act as an interest-free loan to the retailer, paid by the distributor | Trade scheme efficiency is a listed Nivea regional responsibility |

## Primary versus secondary sales: a live warning

Primary sales are what the company dispatches to the distributor; secondary sales are what the distributor sells to retailers; sell-out is what consumers buy. The Mondelez assignment warns that primary sales without secondary movement can merely transfer inventory risk downstream.

Beiersdorf's H1 2026 release shows the pattern at group level: Nivea sell-out stayed positive while shipments into trade fell, with trade destocking and customer conflicts among the reasons given (Beiersdorf). The release gives no India detail, so the lesson is

about method, not about India: a sales manager who tracks only dispatch will misread a destocking quarter as a demand problem.

## Why a distributor might stop pushing Nivea

This answers a likely interview question, "A distributor refuses to invest more. What do you do?", using the course's seven sources of channel conflict.

| SDM source of conflict | How it can show up at a Nivea distributor | Lever Nivea has |
|---|---|---|
| Role incongruity | Nivea treats him as a logistics arm; he sees himself as the market-maker | Agree written roles and the flows he is paid for |
| Resource scarcity | Short supply of a seasonal or launch SKU is allocated unevenly | Transparent allocation rules |
| Perceptual difference | A slow month read as complacency; he reads it as a scheme cut | Share secondary-sales data and review jointly |
| Expectational difference | Nivea plans on growth; he commits stock to a lower forecast | Joint forecasting before the season |
| Decision-domain disagreement | Who sets retail price, who appoints sub-stockists, who owns outlet data | Define decision rights in the appointment letter |
| Goal incompatibility | Nivea wants volume and share; he wants margin per unit and cash rotation | Pay for outcomes that help both, such as outlet coverage and fast settlement |
| Communication difficulty | Scheme terms by circular, delayed credit notes, no grievance forum | Fix first: it is the cheapest source to remove |

## Measuring conflict instead of guessing it

The course gives an index of manifest conflict, summing across the N issues that matter to both sides:

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\text{Conflict} = \sum_{i=1}^{N} \text{Importance}_i \times
\text{Frequency}_i \times \text{Intensity}_i
```

Because the terms multiply, an issue that is petty, rare or not far apart contributes close to zero however loud the argument. A Nivea area sales manager could survey distributors on issues such as scheme settlement, stock allocation, damage claims and quick-commerce pricing, scoring each on importance, how often the parties disagree and how far apart they are. This is a method, not a result: no such data exists for Nivea.

## Quick commerce: the sharpest channel conflict now

The All-India Consumer Products Distributors Federation told the Competition Commission of India in August 2025 that quick-commerce dominance creates a market power imbalance, alleging discounts of 35-50% and supplier contracts that require more stock in dark stores than in the traditional route. Its claimed platform shares were Blinkit 40-45%, Zepto 25-30% and Swiggy Instamart 20-25%. These are allegations in a complaint, not findings. Separately, a Datum study reported by the Economic Times put kirana share at 92.6% in 2023, down from 95% in 2018, and projected 88.9% by 2028; Kearney expects the quick-commerce grocery market to roughly triple from 2024 to 2027 to about Rs 1.5-1.7 lakh crore (Outlook Business).

**Applying the fire-and-smoke matrix.** The SDM course asks two questions: how likely is destructive conflict, and how important is the threatened channel? For the FMCG industry, general-trade distributors still carry most volume (the original report cites 70-75%, an industry figure), and Nivea's own channel mix is undisclosed. If Nivea's mix looks like the industry's, the threatened channel is important, and the distributors' complaint makes the prospect of destructive conflict high. The matrix then says to act now rather than reassure or ignore.

From the course's ten approaches, the ones that fit Nivea best are:

1. **Differentiate the channel offer.** Different pack sizes or bundles by channel, so the same item is not compared on one price.
2. **Create segment-specific programmes.** Distinct schemes for kirana, chemist, modern trade and quick commerce.
3. **Change the channel's economic formula.** Margin or incentive linked to outlet coverage and fast settlement rather than raw volume.
4. **Enhance the channel's value proposition.** Training, merchandising support and category data, which are expert power and renew with use.

The course notes that reward and coercion are spent when used, while expert and referent power grow when used. Training a distributor's salesmen makes the distributor more loyal and more dependent at once. Nivea has not disclosed which of these it applies.

## 7. Sales force organisation and management

Nivea runs two different sales forces under one roof, and SDM's five sales-force decisions (hiring, training, motivation, compensation, supervision) have to be answered differently for each. The roles below come from Nivea's job postings as quoted in the original report; the SDM readings are analytical.

## The roles and their SDM selling situation

| Role | What the postings say | SDM selling role and situation |
|---|---|---|
| Area Sales Manager, General Trade | Responsible for sales performance in an assigned territory | Order getter and manager of the distributor relationship; outside order taker at the outlet |
| Regional Key Account Manager, Modern Trade | Builds chains through alliances, consumer promotions and relationships; keeps an outlet database; runs monthly journey plans | Order getter in a negotiation-led account sale |
| Head of Modern Trade, Cash and Carry and Alternate Channels | Manages three organised-trade verticals; owns annual sales targets | Sales manager setting targets across channels |
| Regional channel roles | Channel-cluster growth, trade scheme efficiency, damage management | Sales support with a control function |
| E-commerce director (hired Jan 2025) | Not described in the sources | Key-account and platform negotiation |
| Distributor salesmen | Not Nivea employees (inferred) | Order takers whose effort Nivea influences but cannot supervise directly |

The last row is the structural point. SDM's channel sessions contrast a sales force you employ with a channel you do not: authority is replaced by flows, power and loyalty, and a quota becomes a negotiation. A Nivea area manager therefore leads through distributor salesmen he does not hire.

## Territory design: an alignment, not an assignment

The course sets out territory design as a sequence: choose a geographic control unit, estimate sales potential per unit, combine units into tentative territories, run a workload analysis of calls, frequency and travel, adjust for coverage difficulty, then assign, build

contact plans and evaluate. It solves a dual problem: the boundary and the call frequency. Central benchmarks with local adjustment agreed with first-line managers are the versions that get accepted.

The course also lists when not to redesign: when coverage is far below potential, when the force is highly specialised, or when sales depend on contacts and referrals. For Nivea, a territory with coverage far below potential needs more outlet calls before it needs new boundaries.

## The five decisions applied to a Nivea field force

| Decision | SDM principle | Application to Nivea (analytical) |
|---|---|---|
| Hiring | The only selective lever; selection should weight attitude and resilience because product knowledge can be taught | Screen fresher MBAs and graduates for rejection tolerance, language fluency and willingness to travel |
| Training | ACMEE: Aim, Content, Method, Execution, Evaluation, a loop designed backwards from a measurable aim | See the ACMEE table below |
| Motivation | Tools: cash and kind, recognition, job design, participative goal setting; Maslow, Herzberg, Vroom and Adams explain why | Seasonal peaks make fair territory quotas essential; an unfair quota demotivates even a well-paid rep (equity theory) |
| Compensation | Higher fixed pay means more control and less incentive; higher variable pay the reverse | Salary plus incentive suits general-trade area managers; a higher fixed share suits missionary-type work such as launching Face and Derma |
| Supervision and control | APES: Annual plan, Profitability, Efficiency, Strategic | See the indices below |

Nivea's actual pay structure is not public, so the compensation row is a recommendation, not a description.

## ACMEE for a new Nivea area sales manager

| Stage | Content for Nivea |
|---|---|
| Aim | Within 90 days the trainee can run a beat plan, read a distributor's secondary-sales report and open a new outlet, measured by outlets billed and strike rate |
| Content | Company and brand knowledge; product knowledge across Body, Face, Men and Sun; customer and market knowledge (kiranas, chemists, chains); selling skills |
| Method | On the job: ride-alongs, coaching, a distributor attachment. Off the job: role play of the shopkeeper pitch, case discussion |
| Execution | Line manager and a field trainer; sessions timed before the winter and summer peaks |
| Evaluation | Reaction, learning, behaviour and results; gaps feed the next Aim |

## Control: the indices to run

The course lists the control indices a sales manager should compute. The original report lists the field versions. Together:

| Index | Meaning | Source |
|---|---|---|
| Calls and orders per day | Activity and conversion | SDM APES list |
| Strike rate and productive calls | Share of calls that yield an order | Original report |
| Lines per call and average order size | Assortment selling and basket depth | SDM list and original report |
| Cost per call and selling expense ratio | Cost of the field effort | SDM list |
| Territorial market share and sales coverage effectiveness | Outcome against potential | SDM list |

| Index | Meaning | Source |
|---|---|---|
| Numeric versus weighted distribution | Share of outlets stocking versus share of category sales they carry | Original report |
| Fill rate and stock-outs | Service level to the outlet | Original report |
| Non-selling activities | Time lost to reporting and claims | SDM list |

The course makes one further point about audits: sales analytics audits the manager's own design choices, such as territory boundaries, quota levels and call norms, before it audits a lazy rep.

## 8. The selling craft: Prashar's toolkit applied to three Nivea buyers

Professor Prashar's mid-term papers attach the same six-part drill to any product and market: factorial chart, pyramid sales, selling triad, requisite skills, effect of a market change, and FABV. Run on Nivea, the drill shows that the same product needs three different pitches. Everything below is an analytical application, not a Nivea-confirmed practice.

### The same product, three markets

| Part of the drill | Kirana retailer | Modern-trade chain buyer | Distributor |
|---|---|---|---|
| X-factor (stir point) | A fast-turning hero SKU at a margin the shopkeeper believes in | Shelf share plus a promotion that earns back its trade spend | Return on capital after stock turns and claim settlement |
| 2 (reinforcing, presented before X) | Brand trust, advertising, ambassadors | Brand trust, range breadth | Brand pull, range, plant and group support |
| 4 (in reserve, used after objection) | Display material, an extra in-policy scheme | Extra promotion funding, planogram support | Credit relief, faster claim settlement |

| Part of the drill | Kirana retailer | Modern-trade chain buyer | Distributor |
|---|---|---|---|
| Strategy | Persuasion | Negotiation | Negotiation moving to Client-Profit Planning |
| Situation | Outside order taker | Creative tangible, key-account negotiation | Creative tangible when appointing; order taker in routine |
| Style | Direct | Commercial | Commercial |
| Key skills | Rapport, quick FABV, objection handling, beat discipline | Numbers, promotion ROI, planogram knowledge, supply reliability | Business arithmetic, joint planning, conflict handling |

The market-change test (part e) is visible here. Move the same Nivea cream from a kirana to a chain buyer and the X-factor shifts from margin on one shelf to trade terms and promotion return, so the skill set changes from relationship persuasion to negotiation.

## Pyramid sales for the kirana pitch

The factorial chart says what to say; the pyramid says when. Factors go one at a time, cheapest to offer first, with the core product at the base, until the stir point tips the buyer.

1. **Core:** the hero SKU the shopkeeper already knows (Creme tin or body lotion).
2. **Reinforcing factors:** brand trust and advertising he sees customers reacting to.
3. **Availability:** a promise of reliable replenishment and fill rate.
4. **Stir point:** margin after the current scheme on the SKU that turns fastest.
5. **In reserve:** display help and a second scheme, held back until he objects.

Terms conceded at the first order become the benchmark for every future order, which the course calls futurity. A rep who concedes the reserve scheme on call one will be asked for it again on call two.

## FABV: feature, advantage, benefit, value

The chain must run all the way to value, the buyer's own priority, not stop at benefit.

| Buyer | Feature | Advantage | Benefit | Value |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Kirana | Brand rated most trusted skincare brand in India for six years (TRA 2026, per original report) | Shoppers ask for it by name | Fast turn, little selling effort | Shelf space that earns more per square foot than an unknown brand |
| Kirana | Several pack sizes and price points | More shoppers can afford a purchase | More units sold per week | Higher footfall value from one SKU family |
| Chain buyer | Range across Body, Face, Men and Sun | One supplier fills several shelf bays | Fewer vendor negotiations | Lower category management cost |
| Chain buyer | Football-led and celebrity-led demand creation | Shoppers arrive pre-sold | Promotions convert more | Better promotion return on trade spend |
| Distributor | Local manufacturing at Sanand | Supply is less dependent on imports for creams, lotions and shower gels | Fewer stock-outs (inferred) | Service level he can promise retailers |
| Distributor | Clear scheme terms and fast claim settlement (a design choice for Nivea to make) | Predictable cash cycle | Better return on capital | A reason to put Nivea ahead of rival lines |

The Sanand plant makes creams, lotions, shower products and lip care; deodorants and soaps are imported. Benefit claims marked inferred are not company statements.

## A shopkeeper call in six moves

The course's approach steps are gaining entry, establishing rapport and winning attention, followed by a need-satisfaction presentation in which the customer does most of the talking. A call on a kirana can follow this order.

1. **Entry and rapport.** Greet by name; let him set the pace; keep small talk short if he is busy.
2. **Attention.** Use a benefit or curiosity opening: "Which skin products do your customers ask for most this month?"
3. **Need discovery.** Ask what sells, what is missing, what he cannot get on time. Listen for the stir point.
4. **Presentation.** Link one or two SKUs to what he just said, using the FABV chain.
5. **Objections and close.** Handle, then close on a minor point such as quantity or delivery day.
6. **Follow-up.** Confirm delivery, check display, plan the next visit.

The original report's advice for the interview prompt "sell this Nivea cream to a shopkeeper" is to open with questions about his customers before pitching; steps 2 and 3 above put that into the course's framework.

## Objections the shopkeeper will raise

SDM groups objections into stoppers (genuine), stalls (excuses) and searches (requests for information), and names tactics for each.

| What he says | Type | Tactic |
|---|---|---|
| "Other brands give me a better scheme" | Stopper | Compensation ("yes, but"): concede the scheme, then show faster turn and fewer returns |
| "I have no space" | Stopper or stall | Ask which SKU sells slowest and propose a swap; offer to arrange the shelf |
| "Come next week" | Stall | Echo and a polite "why", then a minor-point close on a small trial order |
| "How is this different from the other cream?" | Search | Answer with FABV and proof, such as what customers ask for |
| "Customers don't ask for it" | Stopper | Forestall with sell-out evidence from nearby outlets; feel-felt-found |

| What he says | Type | Tactic |
|---|---|---|
| "Your distributor is slow" | Stopper | Accept the problem, log it, promise a fix, and tell the distributor the same day |

### Colours and ethics

The course names incentives within policy as wet selling and unauthorised sweeteners above policy as yellow selling. A rep who promises an off-scheme discount to close creates a precedent the distributor and company then have to honour, and sows conflict. The healing process (surface the need, enlarge the gap, bring the customer to conviction) is legitimate in a shopkeeper pitch only when the need is real.

## 9. Diagnosing a territory whose sales fell 10%

The first question is whether the 10% fall is in primary sales, secondary sales or consumer sell-out, because each points to a different cause and a different owner. The original report offers a three-step approach (diagnose across market, distributor, retailer, competitor and product; prioritise one or two causes; act). SDM gives that approach a sharper order of operations.

### Step 1: Locate the fall

| If the fall is in | Likely meaning | Where to look first |
|---|---|---|
| Primary only | Distributor destocking or ordering less | Distributor stock days, credit position, scheme disputes, conflict sources |
| Secondary and primary | Retail offtake is weak or coverage has slipped | Outlets billed, strike rate, lines per call, stock-outs |
| Sell-out only | Stock is building at distributor or retailer | Danger of a later primary collapse; slow-moving seasonal lines |
| Everywhere | Market, competitor or seasonality | Same-season prior year, competitor schemes, quick-commerce pricing |

Beiersdorf's own H1 2026 pattern, positive sell-out with falling shipments, is the first row at group level: trade destocking made the shipments figure worse than the consumer reality.

## Step 2: Decompose the number

Secondary sales in a territory can be split into three multiplying drivers:

```
\text{Secondary sales} = \text{Outlets billed} \times \text{Orders per outlet} \times \text{Average order value}
```

A hypothetical example, not Nivea data: if outlets billed fall 4%, orders per outlet fall 3% and average order value falls 3.3%, secondary sales fall about 10% (0.96 x 0.97 x 0.967 = 0.900). The cause differs sharply from one where outlets billed alone fell 10%, and so does the fix.

## Step 3: Test the SDM suspects

| Suspect | SDM test | Question to ask |
|---|---|---|
| Territory design | Is the territory an alignment, with workload and potential balanced? | Did coverage per rep drop after a vacancy or a re-cut? |
| Quota and incentive | Is the quota fair, and does the incentive reward the right outputs? | Did an unreachable quota or a threshold effect collapse effort? |
| Distributor | Return on capital, stock turns, claim settlement | Is he earning less on Nivea than on rivals? |
| Channel conflict | Seven sources; index of importance x frequency x intensity | Which issues are important, frequent and far apart? |
| Competitor | Scheme and visibility pressure | What did rivals change in the last two months? |
| Channel shift | Quick commerce re-prices waiting time and bulk breaking | Are shoppers buying the same items online at lower prices? |
| Sales force | Hiring, training, motivation | Is the territory understaffed or the rep weak on specific skills? |

### Step 4: Prioritise and act

Pick the one or two causes that explain most of the drop, then act in the order the course implies: fix communication problems first because they are cheapest, then coverage, then the economic formula. Examples:

- **Coverage fell:** add outlet calls on a re-planned beat, and fix stock-outs.
- **Distributor disengaged:** review return on capital, settle claims, agree a joint forecast, and consider a supplementary distributor only if his capacity is the constraint.
- **Scheme gap against rivals:** test an in-policy scheme on a few outlets before scaling.
- **Quick-commerce price gap:** escalate to the key-account and pricing owners; a rep cannot fix a channel-pricing decision.

Avoid redesigning the territory when the real problem is that coverage is far below potential, as the course notes.

## 10. Cross-check log: the original report against fresh sources and the SDM material

The original report held up on the facts that could be re-opened, with two corrections and one important update. This section records each check so you can see what was tested and what was only carried forward.

### Fact check of the original report

| Claim in original report | Check performed | Result |
|---|---|---|
| Nivea FY2025 sales EUR 5.529bn, +0.9% organic | Beiersdorf FY2025 release | Confirmed (Beiersdorf) |
| Strategy shifts to rebalancing Nivea with more local flexibility, including India | FY2025 and H1 2026 releases | Confirmed that India is named among five markets given greater scope; rebalancing began in H2 2025 and is now an 18-month plan |
| Sanand plant about 80 million units a year | Indian Retailer, 6 May 2015 | **Corrected:** 100 million units a year |

| Claim in original report | Check performed | Result |
|---|---|---|
| Sanand Rs 850 crore, opened May 2015 | Indian Retailer | Confirmed |
| Imports about 60% of range before local manufacturing | Indian Retailer gives 30% import dependence at opening | **Unresolved:** likely different baselines and years; cite neither without the year |
| Real Madrid India fan campaign, June 2026 | Impact, 16 June 2026 | Confirmed; the report omitted that it is e-commerce only and that the article's end date conflicts with its own year |
| Warnery: India top-10, double sales, EUR 500m | Searched; the interview itself was not opened | Not re-verified; carry forward with a flag |
| Job-posting roles (ASM, RKAM, Head of Modern Trade) | Not re-opened | Carried forward from original |
| General trade 12+ million stores, 70-75% of FMCG sales | Compared with Mondelez (3 million stores supported) and Datum kirana share (92.6% in 2023) | Different measures; keep as labelled industry figures only |
| 'The 45 products verified' | Re-read | The report calls it a partial list and the 84-product total excludes Sun, so the wording should say 'a partial list' only |
| Nivea trend | New check | **Update:** H1 2026 Nivea EUR 2.703bn, -6.8% organic; group guidance for 2026 now a low-single-digit decline |
| Nivea India leadership | New check | **Added:** Geetika Mehta MD since January 2024 |

## What SDM tests add to the original sales-role section

The original report's section 6 listed route to market, distributor economics, metrics, channels and category behaviour, and a three-step territory case. Against the SDM syllabus its coverage looks like this:

| SDM topic | In original? | Where added here |
|---|---|---|
| Service output demands and channel flows | No | Section 5 |
| Distributor selection criteria | No | Section 6 and Section 5 |
| Channel conflict, power, measurement | Briefly (tension) | Section 6 |
| Territory design, quotas, supervision, APES | Partly (metrics only) | Sections 7 and 9 |
| Hiring, training (ACMEE), motivation, compensation | No | Section 7 |
| Personal selling process: approach, presentation, objections, closing | Interview prompts only | Section 8 |
| Factorial chart, pyramid, selling triad, FABV | No | Section 8 |
| Case lessons (Nobel Ilac attrition, Weikang trans-territory conflict) | No | Section 11 |

## Where the original and SDM disagree or sharpen

- **Inference stays an inference.** The original labels its GT-through-distributors setup as unconfirmed. SDM insists on naming the flows each party carries, which turns the label into a testable claim.
- **Metrics are not enough.** The original lists distribution and strike rate; SDM adds that sales analytics should first audit the manager's own design choices, such as territory boundaries and quota levels.
- **The conflict is structural.** The original calls the e-commerce discounting issue a tension; SDM treats it as an expected consequence of interdependence, to be measured and managed rather than hoped away.
- **Incentive design can create conflict.** A precedent argued in the Weikang session in your end-term field book is Xurisheng Iced Black Tea, where a volume-tiered bonus reportedly pushed distributors to overstock and dump stock into other territories, and

the manufacturer's margin fell from about 70% to about 30%. Check these figures against the case text before quoting them. The lesson for Nivea: rewarding raw volume invites cross-territory dumping.

## What was read from the SDM folder

The folder holds well over 150 files. Coverage differed by file type, and the table is explicit so you know what the cross-check does and does not rest on.

| Group | Examples | Depth |
|---|---|---|
| Typed field books, one-pagers and cheat sheets | SDM Field Book v2, Class 15, 16 and 18 field books and one-pagers, End-term and Quiz 4 field book, solved past papers, reading notes | Read in the sections relevant to FMCG distribution and sales force; not every page |
| Assignment notes | Selling-strategy, Assignment 5 and 6 notes, comprehensive assignment sheet | Read |
| Group 9 cases and reports | Birla Opus case, Mondelez, TCPL, Amul, Reliance, KOEL, Marlboro, expanded reports, interview guides | Birla Opus and Mondelez read in the relevant parts; the others searched for Nivea and FMCG distribution content |
| Textbook | FedUni Sales and Distribution Management | Contents page only |
| Scanned and image files | Handwritten notes, scanned past papers, case PDFs, class slides | Not machine-readable; the typed field books summarise most of them. OCR of the handwritten notes was attempted but not completed |
| Zip archives | Group case presentations, news presentations | Listed, not opened |
| Audio and video | Interview recordings (Apple, PhonePe, Rayzon Solar, Birla Opus, Rahul Mishra call) | Not transcribed |

A text search across every readable file for 'Nivea' and 'Beiersdorf' returned no matches, so no folder note contradicts or supports a Nivea-specific fact.

# 11. Role and interview preparation for field sales and sales manager positions

Interviewers for a field sales role expect manager-level thinking from the first answer, and the strongest answers name a framework, apply it to a specific channel and say what data would settle the matter. The skeletons below use SDM structures; adapt them with your own evidence.

## Likely questions and answer skeletons

| Question | Framework to name | Skeleton of the answer |
|---|---|---|
| How would you grow a weak territory? | Territory alignment, workload, APES | Split sales into outlets billed, orders per outlet and order value; find which fell; check coverage against potential before redrawing boundaries; fix the one or two causes that explain most of the gap |
| A distributor refuses to invest more. What do you do? | Return on capital; seven sources of conflict; power bases | Ask what his return on Nivea is; identify the source of conflict, starting with the cheapest to fix such as claim delays; invest in expert power, such as training his salesmen, before reward or coercion; escalate only if his capacity is the constraint |
| Sell this Nivea cream to a shopkeeper | Approach, need-satisfaction presentation, FABV | Ask about his customers first; link the hero SKU to what he says; give one benefit-to-value chain; close on a minor point such as quantity or delivery day |

| Question | Framework to name | Skeleton of the answer |
|---|---|---|
| Quick commerce is cutting prices below the distributor. Your view? | Fire-and-smoke matrix; ten approaches | Show you know the dispute is real and distributors have complained formally; say you would differentiate offers by channel, avoid ad hoc discounts, and measure conflict before reacting |
| Primary sales are up but consumers are not buying more. | Primary versus secondary sales | Check distributor stock days and secondary movement; warn that dispatch can move risk downstream, as Beiersdorf's H1 2026 destocking shows at group level |
| Why sales and not marketing? | Selling roles, push and pull | Sales converts pull into availability; cite the Birla Opus insight that margin is the price of coverage; show a concrete example from your internship |
| Tell me about handling rejection or conflict. | Healing, stoppers versus stalls, conflict desirability | Give a real story with a result; explain how you separated a genuine objection from an excuse |
| Are you fine with field travel and targets? | Territory and quota design | Say yes, and ask how quotas are set and whether the territory is aligned to potential |

## Case lessons from the SDM folder worth carrying into interviews

- **Nobel Ilac (Turkish pharma, 337 reps, 23% attrition).** Sir's checklist asked for the cost of attrition (direct and indirect), issues across recruitment, training, compensation, motivation and quota setting, and a comparison of fixed pay, quota bonus, cumulative

quota and overachievement commission as four separate levers. The lesson: use the case's own numbers and avoid invented financial models. Figures from your end-term field book; check the case text.

- **Weikang (trans-territory conflict).** The room reached three different resolutions across sections: agreement, concession and disintegration. The lesson: show your reasoning path, and weigh whether to punish a transgressor against the contagion risk to the channel.
- **Cross-territory dumping.** Link both to Nivea: seasonal volume pushes and raw-volume bonuses are the classic way to create dumping between distributors.

## Talking points on Nivea

- A challenger brand in India with strong trust and a reach agenda, per Nivea's own marketing language reported in the original.
- Growth bets: premium body lotion (Super 10), face care (Milk Delights, Luminous, Derma) and men's grooming.
- A global parent under pressure, with an 18-month turnaround plan and sell-out ahead of shipments in H1 2026, which makes secondary-sales discipline relevant.
- A sales organisation split into General Trade and organised trade, with an e-commerce director added in January 2025.

## Preparation checklist

1. Visit two or three shops, note where Nivea sits on the shelf, which rivals sit beside it and which schemes are displayed, and say so in the interview. The original report calls this the most impressive thing a fresher can do.
2. Prepare two short stories of persuading or handling a difficult person, each with a concrete result.
3. Use internships and live projects as evidence, with numbers for outlets, distributors and growth.
4. Be ready with local-language fluency, basic Excel and mobile reporting, and a stated willingness to travel.
5. Rehearse one end-to-end structured answer for each question above, naming the framework in the first sentence.

# 12. Open gaps and sources

Seven facts that would most change this analysis are still unknown, and each has a realistic way to close it.

## What remains unknown

| Gap | Why it matters | Realistic way to close it |
|---|---|---|
| Nivea India overall market share and channel mix | Decides how much pull Nivea has and how important general trade is | Company disclosure or an industry panel purchase; not available in public sources |
| Distributor names, margins, credit terms | Needed to test distributor return on capital | A distributor interview using the Mondelez interview-guide approach in your Group 9 folder |
| Arrangements with Blinkit, Zepto, Amazon, Nykaa | Decides the size of the quick-commerce conflict | Trade press, platform brand pages, or a key-account contact |
| India's share of Beiersdorf's Africa, Asia and Australia region | Needed to read H1 2026 for India | Not disclosed in either release |
| Full SKU list including Sun | Needed for range depth analysis | Retailer or nivea.in crawl |
| Sanand import baseline (30% versus 60%) | Two sources disagree | Locate the year and definition behind each |
| Warnery interview figures | Not re-verified here | Open the CNBC-TV18 interview itself |

## Sources opened for this report

- Beiersdorf, Half-year results 2026, 3 August 2026.
- Beiersdorf, Full year results 2025, 2 March 2026.
- Indian Retailer, Nivea establishes first facility in India, 6 May 2015.

- Indian Retailer, Nivea India appoints Geetika Mehta as Managing Director, 5 January 2024.
- Cosmetics Design Asia, Beiersdorf outlines plans for NIVEA, Eucerin debuts in India, 19 August 2024.
- Impact, Nivea Men and Real Madrid deepen partnership with India-focused fan campaign, June 2026.
- Outlook Business, FMCG distributors vs quick-comm giants.


## Sources carried forward from the original report, not re-opened

Beiersdorf and Nivea history pages; Real Madrid, The Drum, Inside World Football and SportBusiness for the sponsorship; afaqs, exchange4media, MediaInfoline, FashionNetwork India and Impact for ambassadors; Packaging South Asia, Cosmetics Design Asia, Khaleej Times and India Retailing for entry and plant; Storyboard18 (Sunil Gadgil interview), the TRA Brand Trust Report 2026 release and CNBC-TV18 (Vincent Warnery) for market data; Beiersdorf and Nivea India job postings for the sales organisation; Modaes and Personal Care Insights for group results; nivea.in category pages, accessed October 2026.

## SDM course material used

Prof. Sanjeev Prashar's Term IV sessions as captured in your SDM Field Book v2, the Class 15, 16 and 18 field books and one-pagers, the end-term and Quiz 4 field book, the solved mid-term papers, the assignment notes (Assignments 5 and 6, selling strategy), and the Group 9 Birla Opus and Mondelez channel analyses. The Mondelez and Birla Opus figures cited here come from those group reports, which in turn rely on company disclosures and, for Birla Opus, a primary interview.